

Embed Your PC on a USB and Plug it into Any System!



If you wish to enjoy the convenience of your own desktop even while on the move, this is just the article for you. Learn how to embed your PC on a USB stick, so that it can be used anywhere and on any desktop or laptop.

Did you ever wish you could carry your PC, desktop or OS in your pocket and run it anywhere? This is now possible! You can create or install a full Linux desktop (OS) into your USB stick. This pocket Linux desktop also saves the state, which means that all your files will be saved in the USB for you to carry along. In other words, you will be able to view your desktop in exactly the way you left it the last time. The biggest advantage is that you can insert your USB PC into any modern laptop or computer hardware to launch, reboot and enter your 'personal PC'. This is especially useful when you are visiting friends or travelling abroad and don't want to carry your laptop (carrying around a computer is obviously not even an option). All you need is your USB PC in your pocket!

The pre-requisites are:

1. One USB stick of a size that you can choose (I use a 16 GB Sony 3.0 USB for a reliable and fast response).

2. Temporary USB (4 GB). I used an 8 GB Sandisk USB for this experiment.
3. The latest Ubuntu ISO from the following link: <http://www.ubuntu.com/download/desktop> (I chose 64-bit Ubuntu 14.04 LTS because I have 64-bit hardware computers and a laptop, but you can choose the 32-bit option too).
4. Linux installer: I used Startup USB Creator that is available on Ubuntu Desktop, but if you have Windows, you can use <http://unetbootin.sourceforge.net/>

The procedure

Step 1: First download the latest Ubuntu ISO from the location mentioned in pre-requisite number 3. Use a Linux installer to install the downloaded Ubuntu into the temporary Sandisk USB (see Figure 1).

Though this gives you a live Ubuntu desktop, it's not good enough as it's a trial version and asks for the *Trial/Install* option every time you use it. While installing the temporary

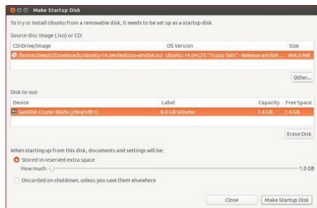


Figure 1: Installing Ubuntu on USB

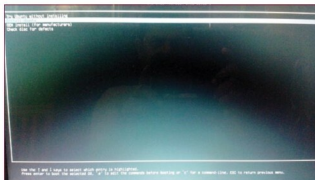


Figure 2: Boot option